

Shafique Islam

PhD Student, Department of Economics

University of Pittsburgh

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Research Interests

Labor Economics, Development Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Public Economics, Economics of Education, Immigration, Technological Change.

Education

University of Pittsburgh

Pittsburgh, PA

PhD in Economics, 2023–Present

M.A. in Economics

Central Michigan University

Mount Pleasant, MI

M.A. in Economics, 2022

University of Dhaka

Dhaka, Bangladesh

M.S.S. in Economics, 2015

B.S.S. in Economics, 2014

Working Papers

Warehouses and Diplomas: Amazon's Expansion and Local Educational Attainment.

Working paper. [\[pdf copy\]](#)

- Estimates the causal effect of Amazon fulfillment center entry on local educational attainment using staggered entry timing across U.S. commuting zones from 2010 to 2023.
- Finds increases in bachelor's and master's degree attainment, with effects operating through household income gains and spillovers to information-intensive establishments and high-skill occupations.
- Winner, Best Second-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh (2026).

When Samples Shape Significance. With Sonia Ale, Lester Lusher, Huda Osman, and Jacob Stenstrom. [\[pdf copy\]](#)

- Studies how sampling variation shapes statistical significance by re-estimating results from top economics journals across independent resamples.
- Documents that statistical evidence can vary substantially even when the research design is held fixed.

Work in Progress

Opportunity or Trap? First Jobs and Immigrant Integration in the U.S. With Gabrielle Toborg.

AI Adoption and the Gender Wage Gap. In progress.

Pre-PhD Publications

Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2022). A panel data analysis of infrastructure, human capital development, and economic growth: Evidence from ten newly industrialized countries. *American Journal of Economics and Business Management*, 5(8), 177–185.

Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2022). Does external debt affect economic growth? Evidence from South Asian countries. *International Journal of Economics and Financial Issues*.

Ale, S. A., Akter, R., & Islam, S. (2018). Remittance inflow and GDP growth: Evidence from Bangladesh, India, and Pakistan. *Asian Economic and Financial Review*, 8(11), 1340–1353.

Rahman, M. R., Selim, M. M. I., Haque, A. U., Smrity, D. Y., & Islam, S. (2019). Examining the effect of exchange rate and overseas employment on remittances: Evidence from Bangladesh. *Theoretical Economics Letters*, 9, 2593–2605.

Sultana, H., Islam, S., Haque, A. U., & Ale, S. A. (2019). Income inequality and economic growth: Empirical evidence from Bangladesh. *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, 10(16), 78–83.

Hossain, S., Kibria, G., & Islam, S. (2018). Does globalization affect the economic growth of Bangladesh? An econometric analysis. *Asian Economic and Financial Review*, 8(12), 1384–1393.

Ale, S. A., & Islam, S. (2017). Do the exchange rates of freely floating exchange rate regimes exhibit mean reversion? *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, 8(20), 81–84.

Islam, S., & Ale, S. A. (2017). Examining the effect of expenditure-changing and expenditure-switching policies on real GDP in Bangladesh. *Journal of Noakhali Science and Technology University*, 1(2), 67–72.

Teaching and Professional Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh
2024–2026

- Introduction to Microeconomics, B.A. course: Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025.
- Introduction to Macroeconomics, B.A. course: Spring 2026.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, Central Michigan University
Jan. 2021–May 2022

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Noakhali Science and Technology University
2021 Nov. 2017–Jan.

- Taught Advanced Macroeconomics, International Trade, and Public Finance.

Lecturer, Department of Economics, Noakhali Science and Technology University Nov. 2015–Nov. 2017

- Taught Dynamic Optimization, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Econometrics, Mathematics for Economists, Statistical Methods, Statistical Inference, and Monetary Economics.

Lecturer, Department of Economics, Bangladesh University of Business and Technology Jun. 2015–Nov. 2015

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant to Professor Bharati Basu, Central Michigan University Aug. 2022–May 2023

M.A. Thesis Supervision, Department of Economics, Noakhali Science and Technology University 2019–2020

- Habiba Sultana, “The Nexus Between Economic Policy Uncertainty and Exchange Rate Volatility: Empirical Evidence from Ireland,” 2019.
- Mohammad Raselar Rahman, “The Effect of Monetary Policy on Stock Market Performances: Evidence from SAARC Selected Countries,” 2020.

Undergraduate Project Supervision, Department of Economics, Noakhali Science and Technology University

- Supervised five undergraduate research projects.

Research Grants

Foreign Direct Investment in Ready Made Garment Industry in Bangladesh BDT 70,000

Co-Principal Investigator, Research Cell, Noakhali Science and Technology University.

The Nexus Between Economic Policy Uncertainty and Exchange Rate Volatility: Empirical Evidence from Ireland BDT 30,000

Principal Investigator, Research Cell, Noakhali Science and Technology University.

Awards

Best Second-Year Paper Award, Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh 2026

For *Warehouses and Diplomas: Amazon’s Expansion and Local Educational Attainment*.

Social Sciences Doctoral Dissertation (SSDD) Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh 2026–2027

Arts and Sciences Graduate Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh 2024–2025

Governor Award, Department of Economics, University of Dhaka	2014
Government Scholarship, Bangladesh	2010

Training

Training in Teaching Methods and Techniques Bangladesh Agricultural University
 Completed a month-long training program from the Graduate Training Institute, sponsored by the World Bank and University Grants Commission Bangladesh.

Service and Leadership

Course Coordinator, Department of Economics, Noakhali Science and Technology University Jan. 2017–Jan. 2021

- Provided course-specific advice to students, monitored enrollment, and prepared annual reports.

Assistant Provost, Abdus Salam Hall, Noakhali Science and Technology University
 Dec. 2015–Jan. 2021

Sports and Cultural Secretary, Noakhali Science and Technology University Teachers Association 2018

Adviser, Royal Economics Club, Department of Economics, Noakhali Science and Technology University Oct. 2018–Jan. 2021

General Member, Economics Study Center, Department of Economics, University of Dhaka

Memberships

Bangladesh Economic Association, 2015–Present
 American Economic Association

Technical Skills

Applied econometrics, causal inference, panel data methods, time-series analysis, text data, large-scale administrative and public datasets, data curation, modeling, and data visualization.

Software: R, Stata, Tableau, SAS 9.4 Base Programming.

References

Available upon request.

Last updated: September 2026